During an inquiry into the possible support networks that the ‘shoebomber’ Richard Reid relied on in Paris, authorities ‘confirmed the existence of channels for sending volunteers from France to the training camps in Pakistan aimed at international jihad.’ At the center of those channels was Ghulam Mustafa Rama, a British citizen who undertook recruitment for Lashkar in France. He was president of the Chemin Droit Association, which French authorities asserted was the representative of the Jamiat Ahl-e-Hadith party in Paris, and had ties to the Jamiat Ahl-e-Hadith in the UK as well. In addition, he was affiliated with the Al Haramain Foundation, which was later declared an al-Qaeda front by the United Nations.[153] Authorities found Rama to be in possession of contact information for operatives in Europe who were connected to various other jihadi outfits and networks as well.[154] Hasan El Cheguer and Hakim Mokhfi, two of Rama’s French recruits, were both known to the French security services because they ‘hung out’ with actors linked to the Salafi Group for Preaching and Combat [GSPC] and the Moroccan Islamic Combatant Group [GICM].[155] They described to authorities how Rama facilitated their training, first organizing and financing a trip to Pakistan in summer 2001. Once there, he drove them to Lashkar’s offices in Lahore and introduced them to Hafiz Saeed, with whom he allegedly had a personal relationship. By vouching for them directly to Saeed, Rama apparently enabled the recruits to move directly on to receiving paramilitary training at one of Lashkar’s camps in Pakistan-administered Kashmir. The two men were training with Lashkar on 9/11 and later told police ‘there were cries of joy’ and jubilation in the camp in response to al-Qaeda’s attacks against America. Both left several days later and traveled to London, where they destroyed their passports before returning to Paris. Although they returned earlier than expected, Rama welcomed them home as mujahideen.[156]

Lashkar had a larger presence in the United Kingdom, where it fundraised and recruited actively from the Pakistani diaspora community as well as through Ahl-e-Hadith mosques. The UK was particularly lenient toward Islamist activism during the 1990s, which led many jihadi outfits to use it as a base for fundraising and recruitment. In January 2002, *The Sunday Times* quoted a senior Lashkar member explaining the scale and destination of money raised: ‘We receive millions of pounds from Britain. British Kashmiris are very patriotic. Some is for charity, but the rest is used